

publishing - get used to the fact that you will have, hopefully, a lot of readers that never actually visit your site. For many with a background in traditional publishing (e.g. many communications directors...) this could be worrying.

2. Thoroughly study what a blog is

You have to know blogs to be able to decide on whether or not to start one. And not just “know” them as a reader of 5 or 10 different blogs. You should do rather extensive research. What are the distinctive features of blogs? What blogs are there in your business? What do you think the audience likes or dislikes about them? With all this done you will still need to find your own tone and niche, and this will depend heavily on who the bloggers are. But you will know what it is like out there.

3. Be specific with purpose

Absolutely no one will be happy if you start a blog because you can. You need, as you would with all other communication channels, be very clear on the purpose. “We will start a blog because...” Just remember that a blog may fill other purposes than you are used to. A purpose like “some of our sales people want a less formal and sales focused forum to share their knowledge” is a brilliant start.

4. Ask yourself, do you really need a blog?

Why on earth would you want a blog? For the purpose above maybe a series of seminars would work just fine. If you have done your research and now know your goal, it is time to ask yourself if it’s worth it. Do you have the culture of openness and honesty that blogging will demand from you? Are there any business risks, and are you prepared to take them?

5. Ask yourself, do we have the resources?

Just one word: Time.

6. Co-ordinate with other communication channels

Nothing strange here, you would never start a new channel without discussing and outlining its relationship with all the other